

Having concept art in pre-production stage is useful for game studios that have to present their game to a publisher.

Making your own prototype

Many game studios come up with a prototype in the pre-production stage now-a-days. This is mainly for promotional purposes. Programmers have to understand what the game is about and start coding the base engine or decide to use any open source or commercial game engines which are suitable to the game. Effective Prototypes are made by developers so that desired and important features are known to people whom you want and game mechanics are tested effectively early in pre-production phase.

Generally for early prototype of casual games, programmers use Flash, Game Maker and several other tools discussed below. But before that, you need to:

- ▶ **Decide the purpose:** Before you begin to make your game prototype, give yourself some time to figure out what you exactly need from this prototype. You want it for pitching your game to the publisher, or you want it for yourself just to test if the mechanics you designed are fun or not, or you want to prototype to test a new UI design you proposed or any other purpose you can think of.
- ▶ **Assemble your prototype kit/tool set:** Selecting the appropriate prototyping tool is not very difficult. You should consider the budget you have to spend on the prototyping tool. In early stages of design, you can use pencil and paper to prototype on paper. This lets you test the mechanics, economy and concept strength of the game. But you often need a digital prototype for video games as a digital prototype allows you to test aspects of your game that paper prototypes lack, like user interface, controls and timing. A programmed prototype is also easy to share with other people and is therefore great for communication and soliciting feedback. You can consider using available prototyping tools as writing one from scratch would be lengthy and will kill the whole purpose of rapid prototyping. Best Solutions tend to fall within the cheap to mid-priced range. The super-expensive solutions are often just not worth it (take more time and money).

Some of best tools for prototypes

FLASHDEVELOP

Flash is without a doubt the best platform for games prototyping. With flash, you can get a games running in a matter of hours. And the learning curve is not bad at all.